

EDUCATION	Columbia University2024 – Present M.A. in Media Studies Research Advisors: James Chu GPA 4.10/4.00 Thesis: <i>Social Vulnerabilities of Large Language Models</i> Brigham Young University–Hawaii2022 – 2024 B.A. in Communication; Minor in Political Science Research Advisor: Mason Allred GPA 3.81/4.00
AREAS OF INTEREST	Social Impacts of AI; Social Media; Well-Being; Trust & Deception; Human-AI Collaboration
BOOK	[1] Outstanding Stories from Kiribati. Emilio Barkett <i>Barnes and Noble Press</i>, 2022.
PUBLICATIONS	[1] Media and War: A Genealogy of the Alternate Narrative. Emilio Barkett <i>Open Cultural Studies</i>, 2025. [under review]
WORKS IN PROGRESS	[5] Imagining the Future: Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development at OpenAI. Emilio Barkett <i>OSF Preprint</i>, 2025. [4] Truth by Default? Evaluating Truth-Bias in Reasoning AI Models. Emilio Barkett, Madhavendra Thakur, Olivia Long, Parker Anderson, Sunny Liu <i>Working Paper</i>, submitting to <i>NeurIPS 2025</i>. [3] Evaluating AI Persuasion Across Socioeconomic Status. Emilio Barkett, Zeming Lu <i>Working Paper</i>. [2] Shared Terrain: Collaborative Dynamics Between Humans and LLMs in Problem-Solving and Conversation. Emilio Barkett, Anna Thieser, Paul Kröger <i>Working Paper</i>. [1] Truth-Bias in Text-to-Speech Generative AI Models. Emilio Barkett <i>Working Paper</i>.
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Columbia AI Alignment ClubNew York, NY Principal InvestigatorMarch 2025 – Present Research Advisors: Yau-Meng Wong, Paul Kröger - Formed research agenda; created experimental design; led writing; technical implementation of Python/API calls; mentored four undergraduate collaborators; managed publication timeline. Columbia UniversityNew York, NY Research AssistantJan 2025 – Present Research Advisor: James Chu - Regression analysis in R; data cleaning; synthesized literature review; prepared survey data; contributed to manuscript structure; asymmetrical collaboration.

	Columbia University <i>Independent Graduate Researcher</i> Research Advisors: Diane Vaughan, Gil Eyal, James Chu Formed research agendas for several projects; developed semi-structured interviews; regression analysis in R; API calls for evaluating LLMs in Python.	New York, NY Aug 2024 – Present
	Brigham Young University–Hawaii <i>UX Research Associate</i> Research Advisors: Curtis Lefrandt, Scott Stiles Ethnographic fieldwork to identify user pain points; synthesized insights into journey maps; presented policy recommendations to the University President’s Council.	Oahu, HI June 2023 – June 2024
	Brigham Young University–Hawaii <i>Data Scientist</i> University surveys through Qualtrics; analyzed data in R; presented to executive leadership.	Oahu, HI April 2022 – June 2023
AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS	AI Policy Fellowship, Columbia AI Alignment Club. Service Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$1,500. Dean’s List Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$500.	Jan 2025 – Present 2022 2022
PRESENTATIONS	Conferences - Beyond Our Screens: Reimagining Critical Media Literacy Symposium, University of Notre Dame, August 2025. <i>Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development</i> - Cultural Studies Association 2025 Conference, California Institute of the Arts, May 2025. <i>Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development</i> - Data Science Day, Columbia University, April 2025. <i>Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development</i> - AI Summit, Columbia University, March 2025. <i>Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development</i> - Artifacts of Control, Lincoln Center for the Performing Arts, Dec 2024. <i>Surveillance on University Campuses</i> - Undergraduate Research Conference, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, Dec 2024. <i>Media and War: A Genealogy of the Alternate Narrative</i>	
ACADEMIC GROUPS	Media in the Digital Age Interest Group, Allan Turing Institute. Oct 2024 – Present Science, Knowledge, and Technology Workshop, Columbia University. Aug 2024 – Present	
RESEARCH METHODS	Quantitative Research: Survey design, regression analysis, text analysis, web prototyping, computational social science, machine learning, natural language processing Qualitative Research: Ethnographic field research, interviews, focus groups, content analysis, speculative methods, think-aloud protocol, usability testing	
COMPUTER & CODE	Python, R, SPSS, VS Code, Qualtrics, L ^A T _E X	
LANGUAGES	English (native), Gilbertese (advanced), American Sign Language (basic)	